

Computer concept intended to use the pervasiveness of the Internet to cater to a larger audience.

The concept did not meet with much success since the cost of PCs reduced and Internet connection speeds were not high enough to avoid long waiting periods as data was being transferred from the server to the client.

November: First All In Wonder

ATI released the All in Wonder range of graphics cards, which, besides including a 3D processing core, also had a TV-Tuner and video capture capability. It is recognised as one of the first of its kind.

1997: Processors, Processors

March: Apple Buys NeXT

Apple Computer acquires NeXT, a company founded by Steve Jobs. The Unix-based NeXT operating system became the foundation for the next Macintosh OS. Steve Jobs was appointed Advisor to the CEO at Apple Computer.

April: AMD's K6

The sixth-generation AMD K6 CPU was released. It offered almost at-par performance as similar Intel offerings, but cost less and could be plugged into motherboards built for the Intel processor, thus presenting a serious challenge to Intel for the first time. The K6 had 8.8 million transistors.

May: Deep Blue Beats Gary Kasparov

IBM's Deep Blue became the first computer to beat a reigning World Chess Champion, by beating Gary Kasparov. Kasparov had prevailed in their previous encounter. Deep Blue, built around a 32-node, IBM RS 6000, high-performance computer, had 256 dedicated chess processors capable of analysing up to 200 billion moves in three minutes. The six-match tournament ended with two matches in Deep Blue's favour and three draws.